

Plant Protection Association of India (PPAI)

Brief History

The Plant Protection Association of India (PPAI) is a scientific society established in 1972. It is non-profit organization, registered under the Andhra Pradesh (Telangana Area) Public Societies Registration Act, 1350 Fasli (Act I of 1350 F.) on 4th December, 1972. Its membership is open to all those scientists interested in promotion of Plant Protection and is dedicated for that cause. As per the 1972 memorandum, it was decided that the permanent headquarters of PPAI would be Hyderabad. The Association started functioning from the location of Central Plant Protection Training Institute and set up its office in the premises of the institute. In 1998, the office set up was shifted to ICAR – National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources and since then has been continuing to operate from this institute till this day. In 2017, PPAI was permitted to construct its own building in an area located under the jurisdiction of Professor Jaishanker Telangana State Agricultural University, Hyderabad. All the set ups of the Association will be gradually shifted to the new building and PPAI new premises will be fully operational by January 2025.

Aims and Objectives of the Association

Since inception, the aims and objectives mentioned in PPAI memorandum have been based on a set of core underlying aspirations of advancing the cause of plant protection research and development, disseminate plant protection knowledge and maintain a consistent link among the plant protection workers belonging to diverse organizations in the country. These objectives have undergone revision and modifications to align with advances in research and development, technologies as well as infrastructure growth in areas related to plant protection. Following are the existing objectives of the Association:

- ✓ To advance the cause of plant protection by encouraging and promoting plant protection research and education in the country.
- ✓ To provide a forum for dissemination of information related to plant protection through a journal.
- ✓ To bring about exchange of views and ideas on plant protection by organising lectures, discussion, seminars, symposia etc.
- ✓ To maintain a link between plant protection workers in India.
- ✓ To involve in any such activity which will be useful for the advancement and adoption of plant protection techniques developed by the scientific community.

Executive Council of PPAI

1. There is an executive council responsible to carry on all affairs of the association.
2. The executive council consists of Honorary Patron, the President; Vice President; General Secretary; Assistant Secretary; Treasurer and Eight councillors. All except the Honorary

Patron (Plant Protection Adviser to the Government of India) will be elected by the General body. All the office bears are elected for a period of two years.

3. The general secretary is responsible for recording the proceedings of the meetings of the association and of the council and for conducting day to day business of the association. The assistant secretary assists the secretary in all matters connected with the association, and shall be in charge in the absence of the secretary. The treasurer maintains the account, receive deposits and disburses money on behalf of the association according to directions of the council.
4. The funds are spent only to the attainment of the objects of the society and no portion thereof shall be paid or transferred directly or indirectly to any of its members through any means.
5. The funds of the association are in the name of the Plant Protection Association of India operated jointly by General Secretary and Treasurer and the latter shall make payments endorsed by the secretary in respect of bills not exceeding ₹100/- at a time, Bills for sums in excess of this amount shall be jointly endorsed by the secretary and the president to the extent of ₹1000/- before they will be valid for payment by the treasurer.
6.
 - i) There is a reverse fund of the association.
 - ii) The reverse fund is not used on recurring items.
 - iii) All the admission fees and 50% of life membership fee received form the reserve fund.
 - iv) The executive council by decision of the general body by two thirds majority, can sanction any expenditure out of the reserve fund but not exceeding 50%.
7. All accounts of the association are audited annually by an accountant nominated by the executive council. The treasurer submits to the accountant by the end of April each year the accounts of the association for the previous year for the purpose of auditing. The auditor's statement of accounts are circulated to all members before the annual general body meeting.

Meeting of the Council

- Council meetings are held periodically at the discretion of the president or at the request of 1/3 of the members of council.
- The date and time of holding each meeting of the council are notified by the secretary to each member of the council at least 2 weeks before the date on which such meetings are to be held. Non-receipt of such notice by any member of the council in no way invalidate the proceedings of the meeting. One-third of the members of the executive council form the quorum.
- Extraordinary meetings of the council are called by the president on a requisition signed by the members of the council.

Meetings of the Association

1. Ordinary meetings of the association are presided over by the President or in his absence by one of the Vice-Presidents or by one of the members of the council present or by member elected at the meetings.
2. An extraordinary meeting of the association is called if one third of the ordinary members of the association send a signed requisition to the general secretary for such meeting.

Annual General Body Meeting

1. The date of the annual general body meeting is announced by the council at least four weeks before the meeting and all notices of motions are received by the general secretary by the end of October. The out-going President addresses the meeting. In case the president is unable to attend the annual general meeting the presidential address is sent and read at the meeting.
2. The venue of the meetings is decided by the executive council.
3. The agenda and resolutions for the annual general meeting are circulated to the members before the date of the meeting.
4. The reading of technical papers are fully encouraged at all meetings of the association. Discussions, purely of plant protection interest could however be held at the annual general meetings.

Amendment of the Rules

1. No amendment or alteration is made in purpose of the Association unless it is voted by 2/3rd members present at a meeting convened for the purpose and confirmed by 2/3rd of the members present at a second special meeting.
2. Proposals for an amendment of these rules are made either by the council or any member duly seconded. In the latter case, it must reach the secretary in writing in time for circulation to all members of the association at least 1 month before extraordinary meeting by the end of October for the annual meeting.
3. The executive council can frame or alter bye-laws for efficient working of the association not inconsistent with its rules.

Activities of Association

The PPAI is working for diverse community of global scientists that provides credible and beneficial information related to plant protection; advocates and participates in the exchange of knowledge among public, policy makers, and the larger scientific community; and promotes as well as provides opportunities for scientific communication, career preparation and professional development for its members.

1. Publications of PPAI

- A. Journal:** In 1973, the Association started to publish a scientific journal called the “Indian Journal of Plant Protection” to advance the cause of plant protection. Earlier, it was published half yearly and later 2012 onwards,, four issues of the Journal are being brought out every year in March, June, September and December. So far 50 volumes of the journal

have been published. The journal is indexed/ abstracted in Bioscience, Chemical Abstracts, Review of Applied Entomology, Review of Plant Pathology, other CAB abstracts and AGRINDEX of FAO.

B. Books/Manuals/Monographs/Proceedings: Plant Protection Association of India has brought out a number of useful publications from time to time. Advances made in the field of plant protection have been compiled and published for the benefits of different stakeholders.

2. Organisation of national/international conferences/symposia/workshops/brainstorming sessions / lectures by eminent scientists:

- PPAI regularly organizes workshop and seminar on various themes related to plant health management. It also conducts meetings of plant protection workers affiliated to ICAR institutes, SAUs, state department of agriculture, private sector agencies and other stakeholders associated with plant protection activities.
- The Society also arranges popular lectures every now and then by eminent scientists/plant protection research workers for the benefit of its members and conducts an annual General Body Meeting with a technical session.

3. Awards by Plant Protection Association of India:

PPAI initiated giving awards to encourage activities and scientists to promote the cause of plant protection in India. Following are the awards instituted and given through the Association.

A. *Dodla Raghava Reddy Memorial Award*

This award was instituted by Dr D V R Reddy former President of PPAI and former Principal Scientist and Leader of Virology, International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics (ICRISAT) in the year 1983 in memory of his late father Shri Dodla Raghava Reddy for outstanding contributions in the field of Plant Protection. The award is given to Indian citizens once in three years constituting a gold medal and a certificate from interest accrued from a fund of Rs 300,000/ (Rupees three lakhs only).

B. *Dr Bap Reddy Award for Integrated Pest Management*

Dr Bap Reddy, an eminent Scientist, who contributed immensely for pest management in India and Asia Pacific for nearly 40 years and retired as FAO representative after serving the United Nations for two years, donated Rs 15000/- over three decades ago for instituting this award. The interest accrued from this amount is given as award once in two years. The award constitutes a plaque, a certificate and cash. This award is given once in two years. The purpose of the award is to promote the concept of Integrated Pest Management (IPM). Individuals whether solely or collectively engaged in development, research or extensions to promote the concept of IPM in India are eligible for the award.

C. *Fellows of Plant Protection Association of India*

Individuals/ Scientists who have completed five years of continuous membership in Plant Protection Association of India are elected as ‘Fellows’ based on their meritorious research accomplishments and contribution towards the activities of the association.

D. *Smt. Kavuri Sarada Memorial Award for “The Best Research Paper” published in the “Indian Journal of Plant Protection”*

Candidates are not required to send proposals for this award as the screening committee appointed by ‘Plant Protection Association of India’ chooses two Best Research Papers published in the ‘Indian Journal of Plant Protection’ every year for the award. The award consists of a certificate to each one of the authors of the chosen research paper for “The Best Research Paper”.

E. *Best Scientist Awards*

- The Best Scientist Awards in Young and Senior Category have been instituted by PPAI starting from the present year (2023) marking the occasion of Golden Jubilee Celebrations of PPAI.
- The awards will be given BIANNUALLY to any individual in recognition of his/her professional contribution in Entomology / Plant Pathology / Nematology and is open to the members of the PPAI who are not more than 60 years of age (for senior category) and 40 years of age (for young category) as on 31st December of the year.
- Award comprises of Citation, Certificate and Cash Prize of Rs.15000/- (Fifteen Thousand only for Senior Category) and Rs 10000/- (Ten thousand for Young Category)

Plant Protection Association of India: 53 years of Progress

During 1972-2025, the PPAI has progressed from a small specialized group of few members with beginnings in the premises of a single central institute to a full-fledged Association of National repute and only one of its kind devoted to the cause of advancement and promotion of plant protection activities in the country. In the last 50 years, PPAI has been managed by a very professional team of scientists and associated research workers aided by skilled supporting group of personnel having experience in financial and administrative management. The association has gone a long way in realizing the original objective of building up a strong network of plant protection workers across the country. Now the association has a strength of 425 life members, over 150 regular members and 100 Institutional memberships with affiliations to organizations of diverse backgrounds. PPAI has also been functioning strictly as per the society guidelines in conduct of its activities through regularly elected executive councils with diverse members from ICAR research institutes, State Agricultural Universities, Directorate of Plant Protection Quarantine & Storage, National Institute of Plant Health Management as well as research workers associated with private sector agencies working in the field of plant protection.

PPAI Activities

Publication of National Journal:

Since its inception in 1973, the publication of the journal, Indian Journal of Plant Protection (IJPP) has been one of the foremost and key activities of the association. Four issues of the Journal are published every year in March, June, September and December. So far 50 volumes have been published and the journal has gained repute as being one of the very few national journals catering to the requirements of disseminating knowledge related to plant protection. IJPP is indexed/abstracted in Bioscience, Chemical Abstracts, Review of Applied Entomology, Review of Plant Pathology, other CAB abstracts and AGRINDEX of FAO. The journal has also been accorded the standard and widely accepted NAAS rating enhancing its acclaim in recognizing the importance of publishing plant protection related research findings in the interest of different stakeholders and with final benefits to farmers.

Organization of Conferences/Workshops/Symposia/Brain storming sessions

The Association has organized the following conference/symposia/workshop so far:

- 1986 - National Seminar on Plant Protection in Field Crops.
- 1988 - National Workshop on Plant Protection in Horticultural crops.
- 1992 – National Seminar on Changing Scenario in Pest and Pest Management.
- 1994 – National Workshop on use of Pheromones in Integrated Pest Management.
- 1995 – National Symposium on Integrated Pest Management and Environment.
- 1997 – National Seminar on Plant Protection Towards Sustainability.
- 2007– National Conference on Organic Waste Utilization and Eco Friendly Technologies For Crop Protection.
- 2012 – International Conference on Plant Health Management for Food Security
- 2016 – National Conference on Plant Health Management
- 2018 - Brain Storming Session on Emerging Plant Protection Technologies: Opportunities and Challenges
- 2019 – Association in organizing “XIX International Plant Protection Congress” (IPPC2019)
- 2019 – Red Palm Weevil Symposium: - Outsmarting the Red Palm weevil: A Global Challenge during XIX International Plant Protection Congress (IPPC2019)
- 2023- Brain Storming Session on Integrated pest management of invasive black thrips (*Thrips parvispinus*) in chilli in Telangana and Andhra Pradesh

Books and Proceedings of Conferences

PPAI has released several important publications during these national and international group events. It has also published brochures, booklets and related material for the benefit of students, researchers, state department personnel and farmers:

- ❖ Plant Protection in Field Crops (Proceedings of the national Seminar, 1986)
- ❖ Pests and pest Management – Changing Scenario (Proceedings of the National Seminar, 1992).
- ❖ Pheromones in Integrated Pest Management (Proceedings of the National Workshop, 1994).
- ❖ Plant Protection and Environment (Proceedings of the National Symposium, 1995)
- ❖ Plant Protection Towards Sustainability – A Special issue of IJPP (Proceedings of the National Symposium, 1997)
- ❖ Resource Management in Plant Protection during Twenty First Century (Proceedings of the National Conference in 2002 in two Volumes).
- ❖ Extended Summaries of the National Conference on Organic Waste Utilization and Eco-friendly Technologies for crop Protection. 2007.
- ❖ Forty years of Plant Protection in India
- ❖ Plant health management for food security – issues and approaches. Plant Protection Association of India, NBPGR Hyderabad. Astraa Publications. Eds. Gururaj Katti, K. Anitha, G.S. Laha, N. Somasekhar, B. Sharat Babu and K.S. Varaprasad (Eds.). 2016. (Proceedings of the International conference on Plant Health Management for Food Security 2012)